



Attitudes, Job Satisfaction and Quality Performance

Chapter 3: Attitudes and Job Satisfaction | Robbins & Judge, Organizational Behavior, 18th ed.

Core message: Employee attitudes shape quality behavior, service reliability, learning, and continuous improvement.

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Learning Outcomes

By the end of this session, students should be able to:

1 Explain the components of attitudes and their relevance to work behavior.

2 Differentiate job satisfaction, organizational commitment, perceived organizational support, and employee engagement.

3 Analyze how job satisfaction influences quality performance, service behavior, and withdrawal.

4 Interpret practical indicators of employee dissatisfaction.

5 Recommend management actions that strengthen attitudes supportive of quality.

Opening Case: When Attitudes Become a Quality Issue

A service unit has clear procedures, but customer complaints are rising. Employees say the work is unfairly distributed, supervisors rarely listen, and improvement suggestions are ignored. Some staff follow procedures carefully, while others do only the minimum. Absenteeism has increased.

DISCUSS

What attitudes are visible in this situation?
How could these attitudes affect service quality?
Which quality problem is behavioral rather than technical?
What evidence should managers collect before acting?

Quality insight

Quality systems do not work consistently when employees are disengaged, dissatisfied, or unwilling to speak up.

What Are Attitudes?

Attitudes are evaluative statements or judgments about objects, people, or events. In organizations, attitudes influence how people interpret situations and choose behaviors.

Cognitive component

Belief or opinion

Example: “The quality procedure is useful.”

Affective component

Feeling or emotion

Example: “I feel proud when we reduce errors.”

Behavioral component

Intention to act

Example: “I will report a nonconformity.”

Quality application: To change quality behavior, managers must address beliefs, feelings, and intended actions—not only issue instructions.

Attitudes and Behavior: Cognitive Dissonance

Cognitive dissonance occurs when a person experiences inconsistency between attitudes and behavior, or between two attitudes.

Example

An employee believes that safety and quality matter, but skips a verification step to save time.

Possible reactions

Change behavior, justify the behavior, reduce the importance of the issue, or seek support from others.

Managers should reduce pressures that push employees to act against quality values.

Quality culture is stronger when procedures, incentives, and leadership messages are consistent.

Do not ask people to “prioritize quality” while rewarding only speed or volume.

Major Job Attitudes in Organizations

Job satisfaction

Positive feeling about a job resulting from evaluation of its characteristics.

Job involvement

Degree to which people identify psychologically with their job and performance.

Organizational commitment

Identification with the organization and desire to remain part of it.

Perceived organizational support

Employees' belief that the organization values their contribution and cares about their well-being.

Employee engagement

Involvement, satisfaction, and enthusiasm for the work performed.

Quality orientation

Practical tendency to follow standards, report problems, learn, and improve.

Quality managers should monitor attitudes because they are early signals of future quality behavior.

Measuring Job Satisfaction

Job satisfaction can be measured globally or through multiple job facets. Both approaches are useful, but each answers a different question.

Single global rating

One overall question.

Example: “Overall, how satisfied are you with your job?”

Facet-based measure

Several dimensions: pay, supervision, work conditions, colleagues, workload, growth, recognition.

For quality improvement, facet measures are often more diagnostic.

Measure employee experience together with quality outcomes: complaints, rework, errors, waiting time, and customer satisfaction.

Combine survey data with interviews, turnover, absenteeism, and process indicators.

What Drives Job Satisfaction?

Work itself

Meaningful tasks, autonomy, role clarity, manageable workload.

Supervision

Respect, fairness, feedback, coaching, and listening.

Coworkers

Support, cooperation, trust, and shared responsibility.

Rewards

Fair pay, recognition, and credible link between contribution and reward.

Growth

Training, career development, learning and participation in improvement.

Quality climate

Psychological safety, process support, and non-blame reporting.

Implication: Satisfaction is influenced by system design, not only individual personality.

Consequences of Job Satisfaction

Satisfied employees are more likely to contribute positively to performance and less likely to withdraw from work.

Performance

Higher motivation, service effort, attention to detail, and reliability.

Organizational citizenship

Helping, cooperation, voluntary problem solving, and support for improvement.

Customer satisfaction

Employee attitudes shape service climate and customer experience.

Reduced withdrawal

Lower absenteeism, turnover intentions, and counterproductive behavior.

Quality learning

More willingness to report errors, discuss problems, and participate in improvement.

Employee Responses to Dissatisfaction

The exit–voice–loyalty–neglect model helps managers interpret how employees respond when they are dissatisfied.

Exit

Leaving the organization or seeking transfer.

Voice

Constructive attempt to improve conditions.

Loyalty

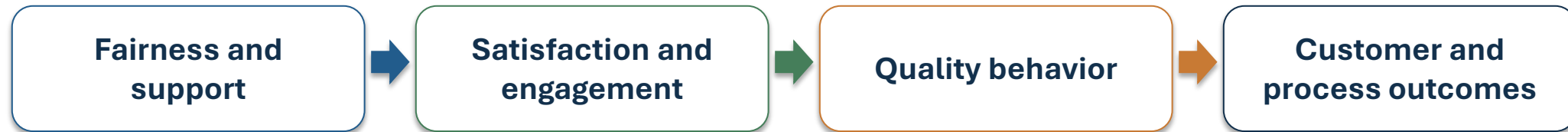
Waiting optimistically for improvement.

Neglect

Reduced effort, lateness, absenteeism, or errors.

Quality goal: Build conditions where employees choose voice instead of exit or neglect.

The Attitude–Quality Performance Chain



People who feel respected and supported are more willing to contribute effort and ideas.
Engaged employees are more likely to follow standards and solve problems.
Quality outcomes improve when the system supports desired behavior consistently.

Managerial Actions to Strengthen Quality-Supportive Attitudes

Listen and respond

Use employee feedback to identify friction points in the quality system.

Recognize quality behavior

Reward error reporting, teamwork, learning, and customer focus—not only output volume.

Reduce unfairness

Clarify roles, workload, decision rules, and opportunities.

Build psychological safety

Make it safe to report problems and challenge weak processes.

Connect work to purpose

Show how each role affects service users and quality outcomes.

Use evidence

Track satisfaction, engagement, complaints, errors, absenteeism, and improvement participation.

Do not treat attitudes as “soft issues”: they are leading indicators of system performance.

In-Class Activity: Diagnose Attitudes Behind Quality Problems

Small groups | 20 minutes

Select one quality problem: complaints, rework, waiting time, nonconformities, absenteeism, or poor cooperation.
Identify the visible employee attitudes and dissatisfaction responses.
Classify causes: job satisfaction, commitment, perceived support, engagement, fairness, or workload.
Explain how attitudes affect quality behavior and outcomes.
Recommend two management actions and one indicator to monitor improvement.

Deliverable

A one-page diagnostic map: Attitude issue → Behavior → Quality outcome → Intervention → Indicator

Mini Case: The Silent Quality Team

A quality improvement team meets weekly, but few members speak openly. Several employees believe management already made the decision. They attend meetings but rarely contribute. Complaints continue, and the team reports “no major barriers.” Informally, staff say they are tired of improvement initiatives that create more work but no recognition.

Which job attitudes are likely present?

Which response to dissatisfaction is most visible: exit, voice, loyalty, or neglect?

What is the quality risk of silence?

What should the team leader change immediately?

What evidence would confirm your diagnosis?

Knowledge Check

1. Attitudes include cognitive, affective, and _____ components.
2. Which job attitude reflects enthusiasm and involvement in work?
3. What is one quality risk of employee neglect?
4. Give one indicator that may signal dissatisfaction.
5. Why is employee voice important for quality improvement?

Use as a quick oral check, poll, or Google Forms quiz after the live session.

Week 3 Assignment: Attitude–Quality Diagnostic Note

Individual assignment | 500–700 words

Select a real or familiar workplace quality problem.

Identify the employee attitude issue most relevant to the problem.

Explain the behavior and quality outcome it may produce.

Use at least two Chapter 3 concepts.

Recommend two management actions and one measurable indicator.

Assessment focus

Conceptual accuracy • quality connection • practical diagnosis • feasibility • academic clarity

Key Takeaways

1 Attitudes are evaluative judgments that influence behavior.

2 Job satisfaction and engagement matter for quality performance.

3 Dissatisfaction may produce exit, voice, loyalty, or neglect.

4 Employee voice is a major source of quality learning.

5 Quality managers should use evidence to monitor attitudes and outcomes.

Preparation for Week 4

Next week: Emotions and Moods

Read Chapter 4: Emotions and Moods.

Read selected parts of Chapter 5: Personality and Values.

Prepare one example of how emotions affect customer service or quality behavior.

Reflect on your own work values and how they influence quality decisions.

Thank you